Girls in Nigeria, 2026: six numbers that matter.

A short, sourced brief for people who can open doors for girls: teachers, mentors, funders, journalists and anyone who makes decisions that reach them.

48.8%

of girls of junior-secondary age attend junior secondary school.

Fewer than half are in the classroom where they should be. The rest have dropped out, never enrolled, or are behind.

Net attendance rate, lower secondary, girls. MICS 2021, via UNICEF Nigeria (Feb 2025).

1 in 3

young women were married before 18.

33.4% of women aged 20–24. Child marriage cuts schooling short and moves big decisions out of a girl's hands.

Nigeria Demographic and Health Survey (NDHS) 2023–24.

14.8%

of young women aged 15–19 have been pregnant.

Early pregnancy is one of the most common points where school ends for a girl.

NDHS 2023–24, Key Indicators Report.

13.7%

of adolescent girls use the internet at least once a week.

Most scholarships, jobs and learning now start online. Most girls are not there yet.

UNICEF Nigeria, "Better outcomes, for every girl" (Feb 2025).

11.4%

of girls aged 15–19 own a bank account.

Without one, it is harder to save, receive a scholarship or get paid for work.

UNICEF Nigeria (Feb 2025).

19%

of women have experienced physical violence since age 15.

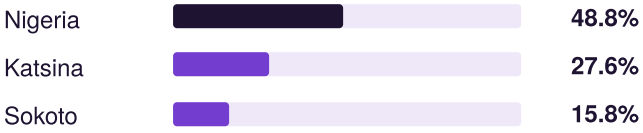
Down from 31% in 2018, so change is possible. But fewer survivors are seeking help, so services must keep up.

NDHS 2023–24, reported by UN Women (Jun 2026).

Where a girl lives changes the odds.

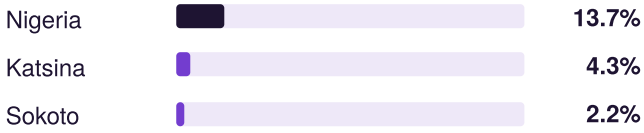
National averages hide very large gaps between states.

GIRLS IN JUNIOR SECONDARY SCHOOL



Net attendance rate, lower secondary. MICS 2021, via UNICEF Nigeria.

ADOLESCENT GIRLS ONLINE WEEKLY



UNICEF Nigeria (Feb 2025).

The law already protects girls, on paper.

Child Rights Act 2003

Sets 18 as the minimum age of marriage. It applies in a state only after that state adopts it, and not every state has.

VAPP Act 2015

Criminalises many forms of violence against persons, including rape and harmful traditional practices. States pass their own versions.

Where it applies

The VAPP Act applies directly in the FCT. Each state must pass its own version. The test is enforcement and access to justice.

What you can do this month.

Mentor
Join our mentor pool. Every mentor is screened before meeting a girl.

Share an opportunity
Send scholarships, programmes and internships for girls to info@gccaing.com.

Connect a school
Introduce us to a principal, teacher or PTA in the FCT, Plateau, Kogi or Nasarawa.

Back the work
Fund, partner or volunteer. Start at gccaing.com.

How to read these numbers. They come from different surveys and years: the latest we could verify in October 2026. Survey figures are estimates. Reported-case figures undercount. The source sits under each figure.

About GCCAI. Girl Child Care Advancement Initiative is a Nigerian nonprofit, founded in 2018, that helps girls get past the financial, social and cultural barriers between them and education, safety and opportunity. You are receiving this because you joined **Closer**, our monthly letter for people who open doors for girls.
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